GUIDE · HOW TO USE THE PORTAL

A quick guide to the Oro Data Portal

New here? This page walks you through everything the portal can do — in plain language, with no technical background needed. It takes about five minutes to read.

What it is | The five areas | Using the map | Live monitoring | Analysing a site | Document archives | Who sees what | Data & limits

What is this portal?

The Oro Data Portal is a single place to explore maps and information about the land, forests, water and biodiversity of Oro (Northern) Province in Papua New Guinea — with a special focus on the **Managalas Conservation Area**, one of the largest community-led conservation areas in the Pacific.

It brings together free satellite data and the region's own records so that communities, landowners, government staff, researchers and partners can see what is happening to the landscape and make better-informed decisions. Everything on the public pages is open to anyone — no account needed.

Finding your way around

The menu at the top has five areas. Here is what each one does.

Map

An interactive map of Oro. Switch layers on and off to see forests, forest loss, protected areas, land cover and more.

Site analysis

Draw or upload any site and get an instant profile — its size, what it overlaps, and an EUDR deforestation check.

Live data

Up-to-date signals for the whole province: active fires, forest-clearing alerts and climate conditions.

Archives

A searchable library of historical documents about Managalas and its partners — read inside the portal.

Home

The front page: a tour of the datasets and the latest live figures at a glance.

Using the map

Open Map and try these.

1 Pick a background

Use the **Basemap** dropdown (top-left) to switch between satellite imagery and a plain map. Tap ⊕ **Oro** to recentre on the province.

2 Turn layers on and off

The list on the left is grouped — Boundaries, Forest change, Forest cover, Land cover and so on. Tick a box to show that layer; untick to hide it. You can show several at once.

3 Read the legend

Each layer you switch on adds its colours to the legend so you can tell what you are looking at. The small coloured squares next to each layer name are a quick key.

4 Watch change over time

Switch on **Deforestation timeline** and a slider appears at the bottom of the map. Drag it, or press play, to watch where forest was cleared year by year.

What the main layers mean

Forest loss	Places where tree cover was removed (Hansen/UMD, 2001 onward). Red marks where forest was cleared.
Forest 2020	The official EU benchmark map of what counted as forest at the end of 2020 (JRC GFC2020). It is the reference for the EUDR deforestation rules.
Clearing alerts	Recent, near-real-time signals that forest may have just been cleared (GLAD-L, with RADD radar as a cross-check). Useful for spotting new activity.
Protected areas	The Managalas Conservation Area and other protected areas in Oro.
Land cover	What covers the ground — forest, cropland, grassland, built-up, water — from ESA WorldCover.

Reading the live monitoring cards

On the Home page these cards refresh automatically. Here is how to read them.

🔥 **Active fires**	Heat detected by satellites in the last few days (NASA FIRMS), counted within Oro. A higher number means more burning — often garden or grassland fires.
🟣 **Clearing alerts**	Likely forest-clearing events in the last 90 days (GLAD-L). Each is an early warning to look closer, not a confirmed loss.
🌳 **Forest loss**	The running total of tree-cover loss since 2001 (Hansen). Open the map's timeline slider to see where and when.
🌧️ **Climate & fire risk**	The Southern Oscillation Index (NOAA). Strongly negative values signal El Niño — drier weather and higher fire risk for the region.

🕒 **How fresh is it?** Fire and clearing alerts update daily; the climate index monthly; the forest-loss totals once a year when the global dataset is released. Each card shows the date of its latest data.

Analysing a site, step by step

The Site analysis tool builds a short profile for any area you choose.

1 Define your site

Draw a polygon (click each corner, then **Finish**), drop a point that becomes a circle, or upload a boundary file (GeoJSON or KML). It works for anything from a half-hectare garden to a thousand-hectare concession.

2 Read the basics

You immediately see the site's **area**, whether it sits inside **Oro Province**, and how much of it overlaps the **Managalas Conservation Area** or other protected areas.

3 Check the EUDR deforestation screen

A coloured bar splits the site into three parts: **standing forest** (green), **land that was already non-forest in 2020** (tan), and **forest cleared since 2020** (red). The last one is what the EU deforestation rules care about. A green verdict means none was cleared; amber and red flag a share to check.

4 See the satellite themes

Below that you get the site's **forest cover & loss**, its **land cover** broken down by type, and recent **fire activity** — each as a simple number or bar. More themes (canopy height, carbon, climate) are being added.

5 Save or share it

Press **Print / Save as PDF** to keep a copy of the report.

⚠️ **A screening tool, not a legal ruling.** The EUDR check uses global satellite products to flag areas worth a closer look. It is not an official or legal EUDR determination — always confirm on the ground and through official channels before any sourcing decision. Nothing you draw or upload is saved or shared; it is analysed in your browser only.

Searching the document archives

The Archives hold scanned historical documents about Managalas and its partners.

1

Search, don't browse

Type a keyword — a place, a person, a species, a year — into the search box. The portal searches the full text of the documents and lists the matches. There is no bulk download, so the collection stays protected.

2

Read inside the portal

Open a result to read it page by page in the built-in reader. You never leave the portal, and the file loads a page at a time so it works on slow connections.

3

Some collections are catalogue-only

A few archives (such as QABB and CSIRO) show their titles and keywords so you know they exist, but the documents themselves are withheld until permission to publish them is cleared.

Who can see what

Most of the portal is open to everyone. A few richer or more sensitive layers sit behind a sign-in.

Public

No login

- Maps, forest change and land cover
- Live fire, clearing and climate signals
- Site analysis and the EUDR screen
- The public document archive

Registered

Free account

- Everything in Public
- Higher-resolution imagery
- Layer downloads and report subscriptions

Partner

By agreement

- Everything in Registered
- Sensitive datasets (e.g. precise species sites)
- Restricted partner archives

About the data & its limits

The portal draws on trusted, free global datasets and the region's own records. The satellite layers are updated automatically on a schedule, so figures change as new data arrives.

- **It is a guide, not the last word.** Satellite data is powerful but imperfect — cloud, small clearings and mapping limits mean figures are indicative. Check on the ground where decisions depend on it.
- **The EUDR screen is an indication only**, built on global products — not a legal determination.
- **Sensitive information is protected.** Precise locations of endangered species and unpublished documents are withheld.

Main sources: WDPA · JRC (GFC2020, TMF) · Hansen/UMD · NASA FIRMS · GLAD-L · ESA WorldCover · ETH canopy height · WorldClim · NOAA · WWF HydroSHEDS. Full credits are on the Credits page.

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